

Enhancing Productivity with Google NotebookLM

Estimated time: 30 minutes

Welcome to the lab on Enhancing Productivity with Google NotebookLM. .

Learning objectives

After completing this lab, you will be able to:

- Utilize Google NotebookLM's interactive features for organizing, summarizing, and synthesizing information
- Experiment with structuring notes, generating outlines and summaries, and brainstorming ideas for projects

Introduction

This lab aims to demonstrate how Google NotebookLM can be a powerful tool for extracting, organizing, and summarizing information, conducting in-depth research, and streamlining notetaking. Through the exercises in the lab, you'll explore NotebookLM features such as summarizing content, generating outlines, answering questions based on uploaded sources, and brainstorming ideas.

Accessing Google NotebookLM

To work with Google NotebookLM, you need a Google account. If you do not have a Google account, visit the following page and follow the steps to create one.

<https://support.google.com/accounts/answer/27441?hl=en>

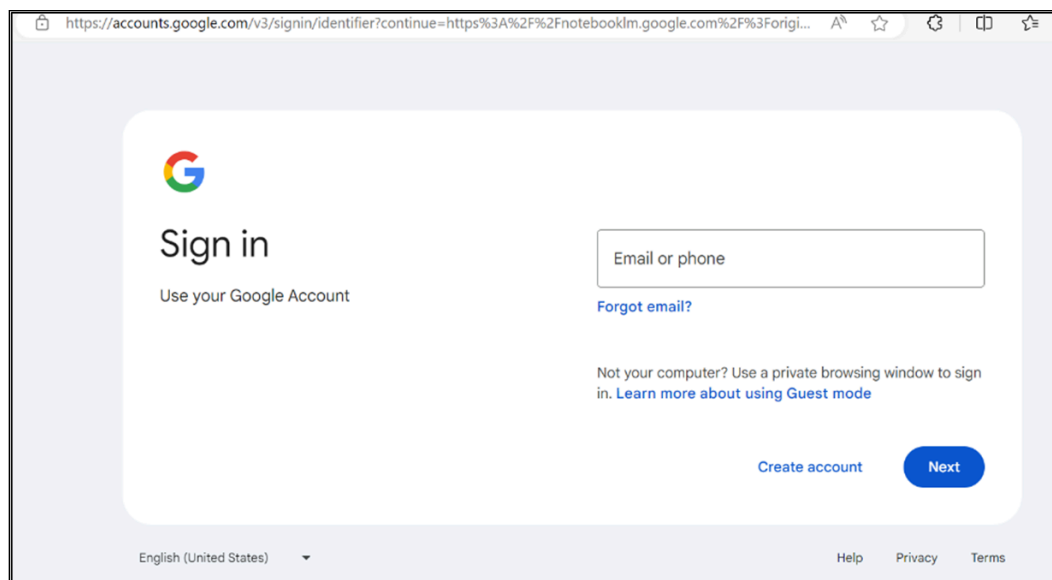
Log in to Google NotebookLM

1. Click the following link to access [Google NotebookLM](#).

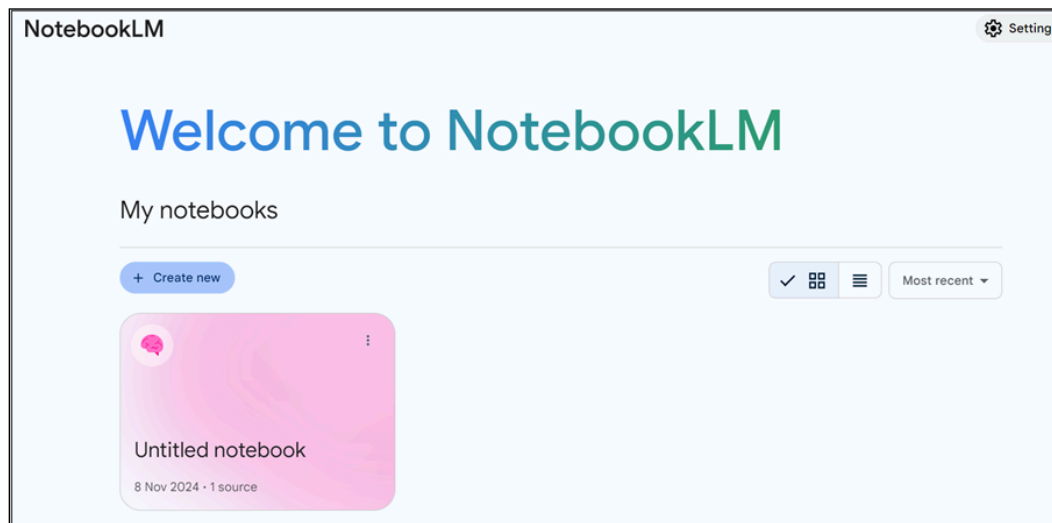
Note: If you cannot access Google NotebookLM by clicking on the link, copy the following URL and paste it into a browser.

<https://notebooklm.google.com/>

2. If you are not logged into your Google account, you will be navigated to the Google Sign-in page. Sign in using your Google account.



3. Once signed in, you will be navigated to the **NotebookLM Welcome** page.



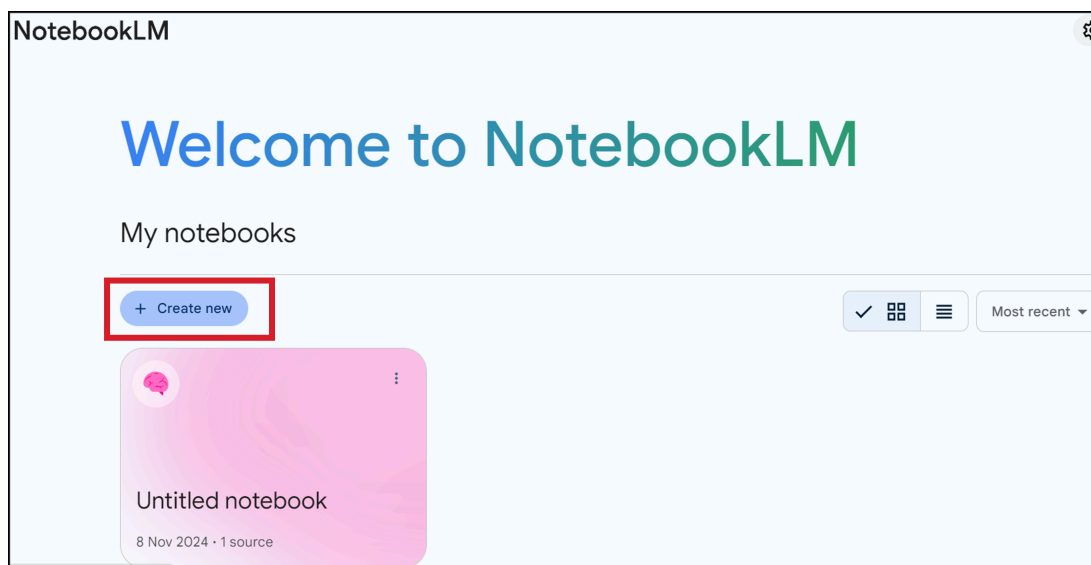
Exercise 1: Leveraging NotebookLM for Research

Peter, a freelance writer, is researching current trends in remote work to create a blog post. He uses NotebookLM to analyze and summarize the source content - a report on remote work statistics and current trends.

Let's explore how Peter can use NotebookLM for this project.

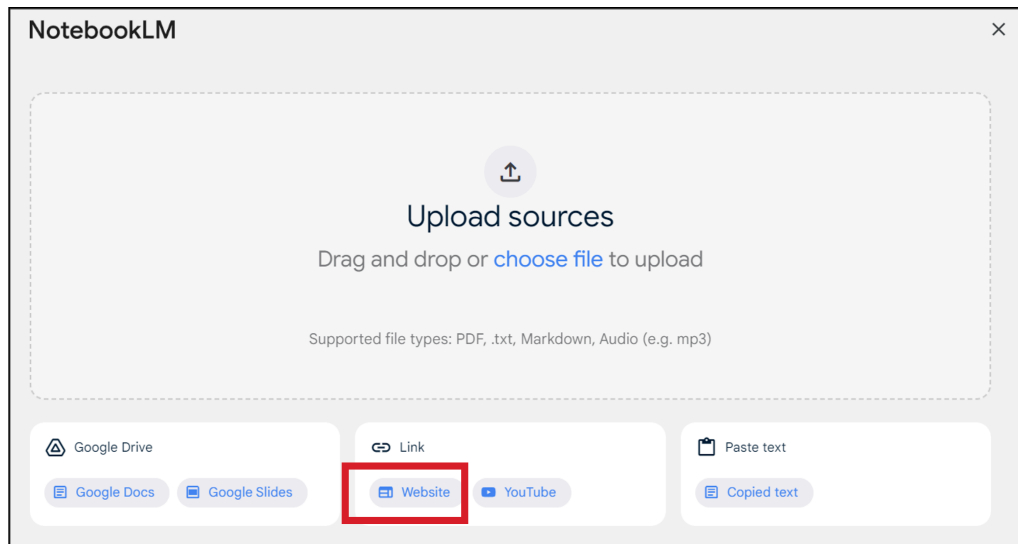
Step 1: Create a new notebook and upload the first source

1. To create a new notebook, click the **Create new** button.



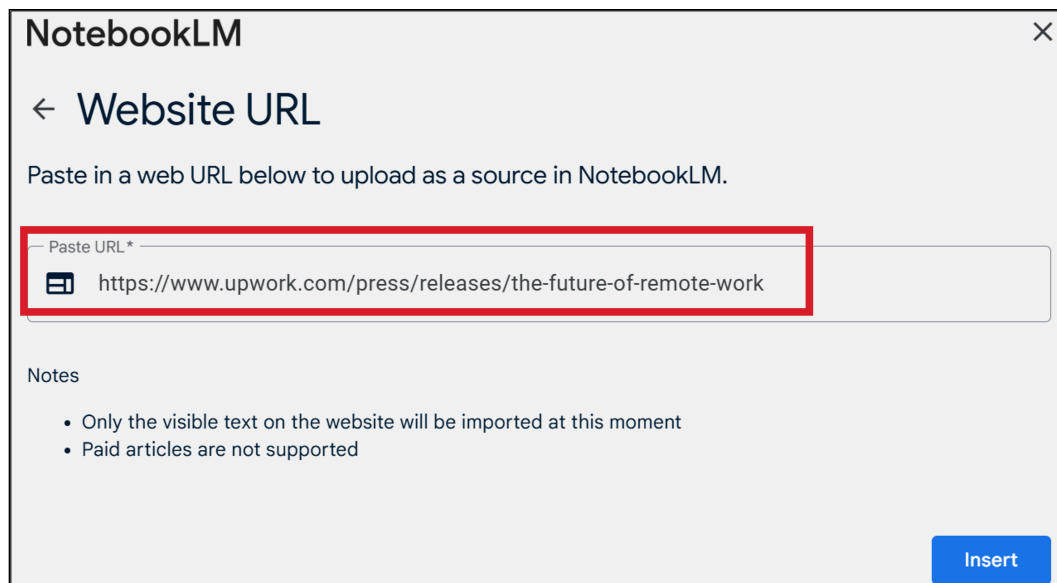
2. A dialog box is displayed that prompts you to upload sources in your notebook. Let's add the first source by pasting the web URL for a report.

1. In the Add sources dialog box, select **Website** under the Links section.



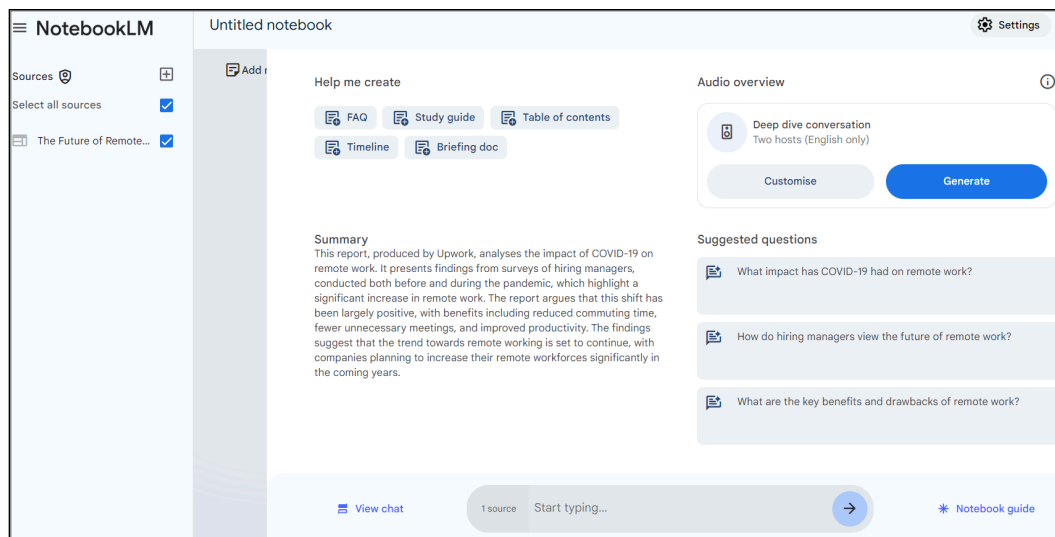
2. In the Website URL box, paste the URL for the website you want to add as a source. For this exercise, you can copy the following URL and paste it. Click **Insert**.

<https://www.upwork.com/press/releases/the-future-of-remote-work>

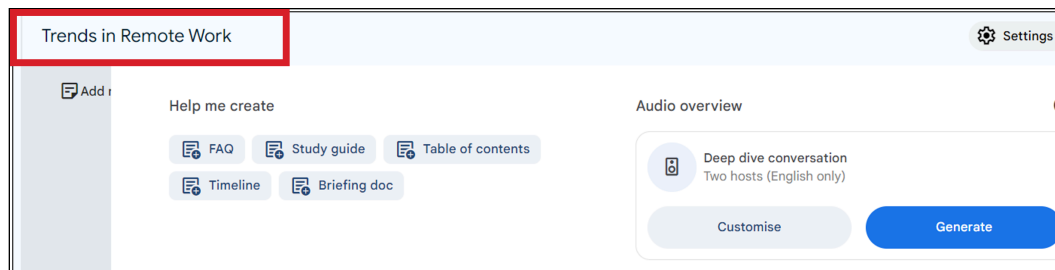


You will have the notebook created with the source added in the Sources panel on the left.

In the right panel, you will see the **Source Guide** displaying the summary of the source (the uploaded PDF in this case) and **suggested questions** that you can ask to explore the content of the source. The default options to generate the **guides in various formats, such as FAQ, briefing document, timeline, table of contents, or study guide**, are displayed on the top in the right panel. The **Audio overview** function is displayed on the top right.



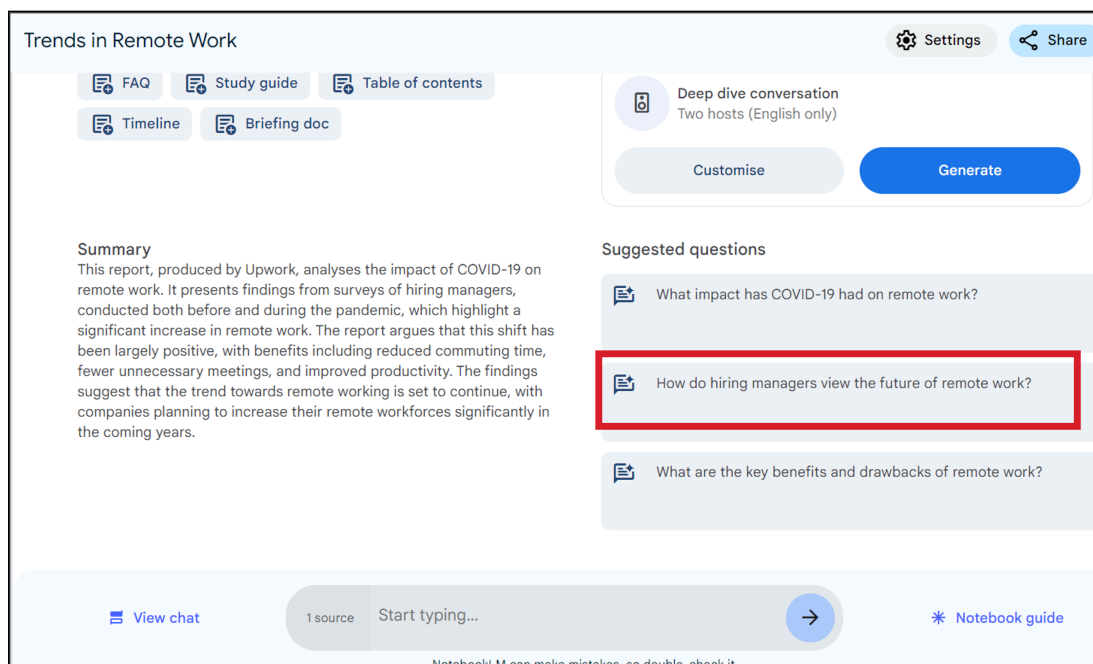
iii. Assign a specific name to the notebook, like "Trends in Remote Work" At the top, click the box that shows 'Untitled notebook' and type in the name you'd like to give your notebook.



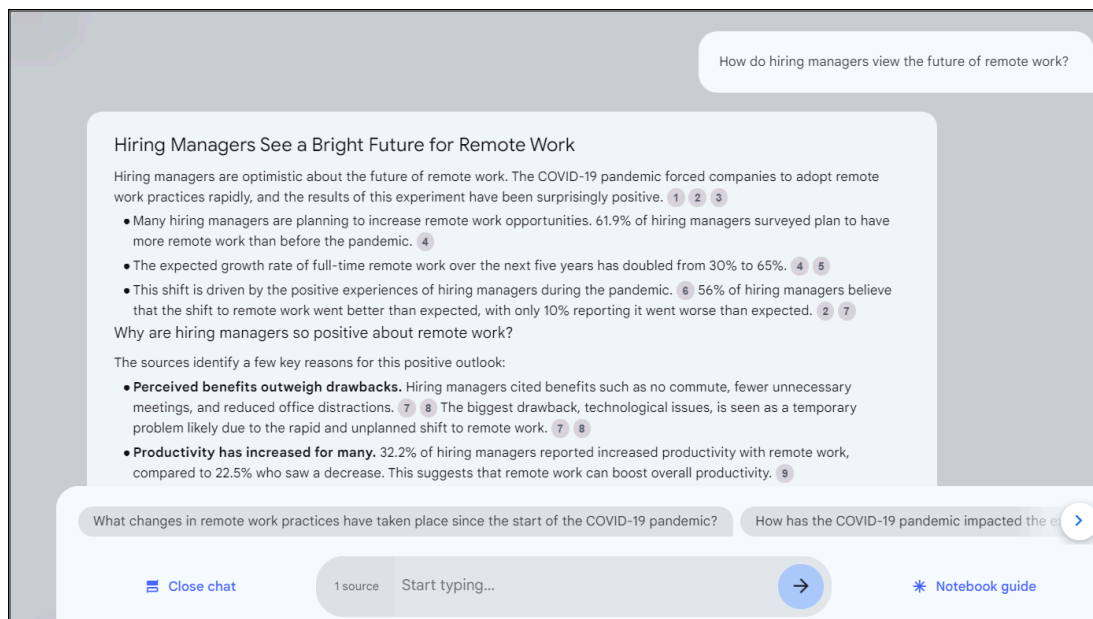
Step 2: Explore the topic through suggested questions

NotebookLM analyzes your uploaded sources to offer suggested questions, which you can select as prompts for the chatbot to generate responses, assisting you in exploring your research topic.

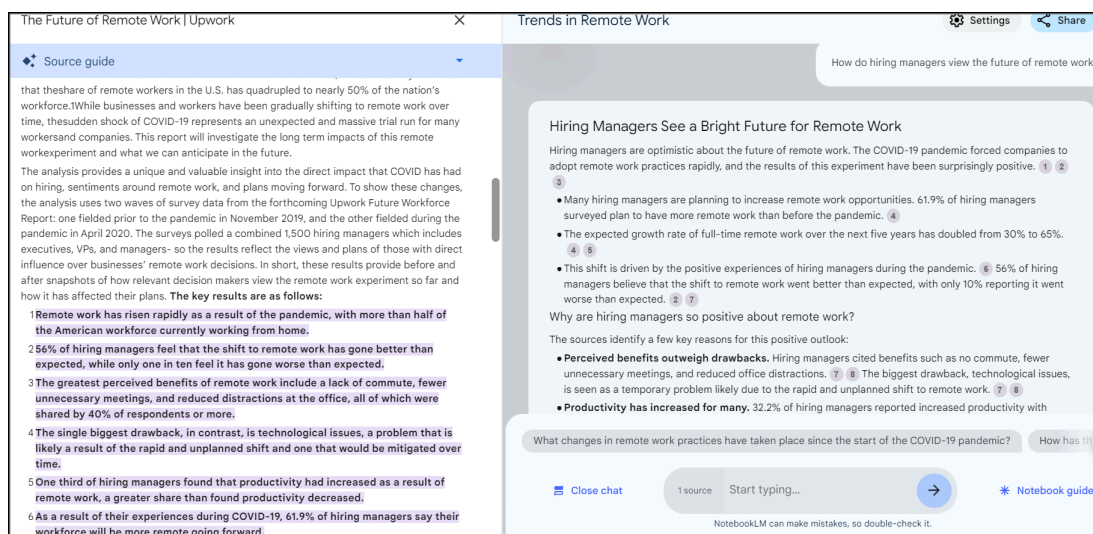
1. Select a question in the **Suggested questions** section.



The response generated by the NotebookLM chatbot at our end is displayed.



2. Note that the response includes inline citations. Click on a citation number to see which section of the source the response comes from.

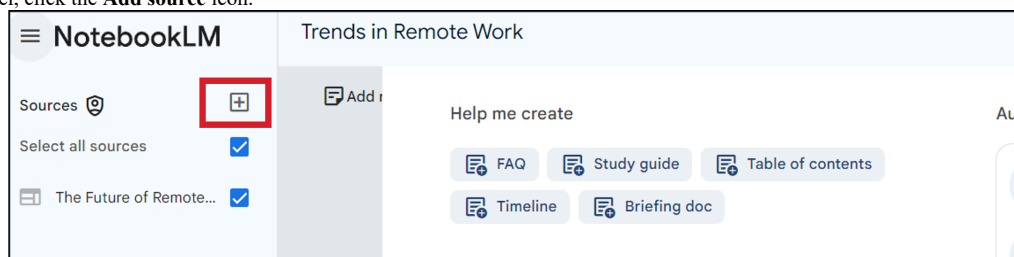


Step 3: Generating conversational audio using Audio overview

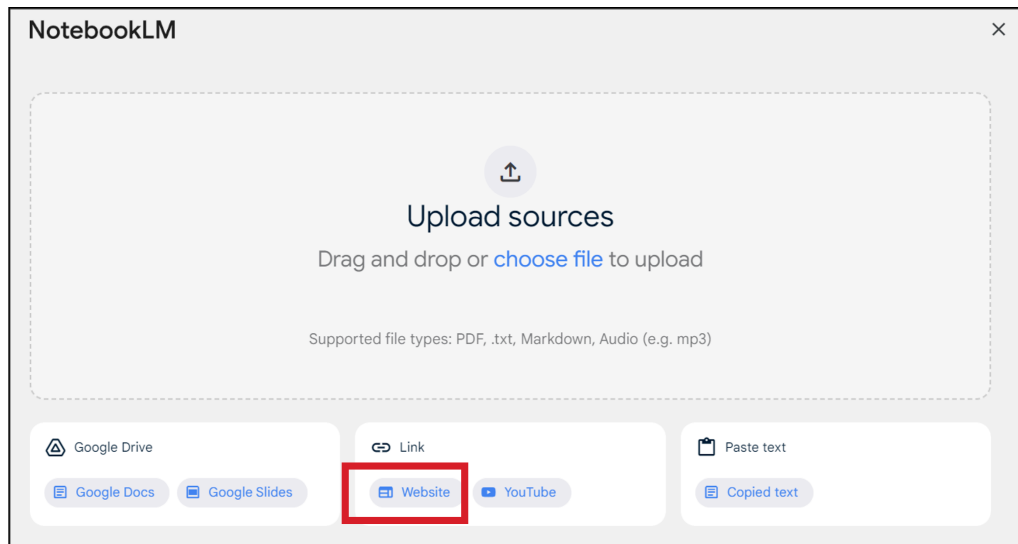
In his blog, Peter aims to highlight the impact of remote work on employees. To do this, he has reviewed additional articles and research materials on the topic. He plans to examine various perspectives and arguments, taking a critical-thinking approach to the discussion. The Audio overview feature can support him by generating an in-depth conversation between two AI hosts—either based on summaries of the uploaded sources or customized to focus on specific topics or aspects within those sources.

1. Let's add another website URL as the source—a research briefing on the impact of remote and hybrid working on workers and organizations.

1. In the Sources panel, click the **Add source** icon.

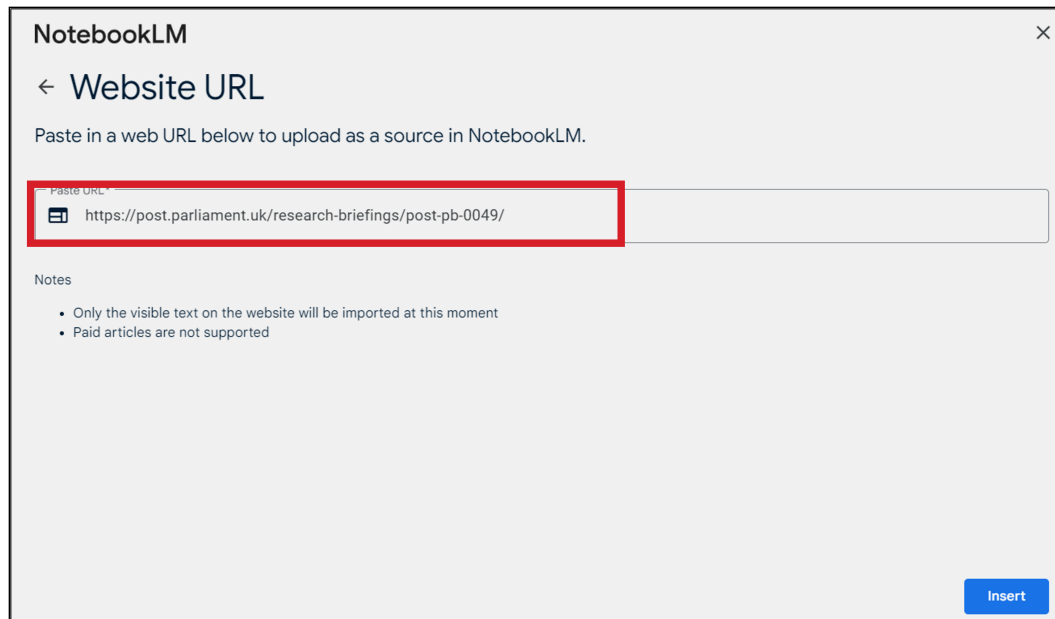


2. In the Add sources dialog box, select **Website** under the Links section.



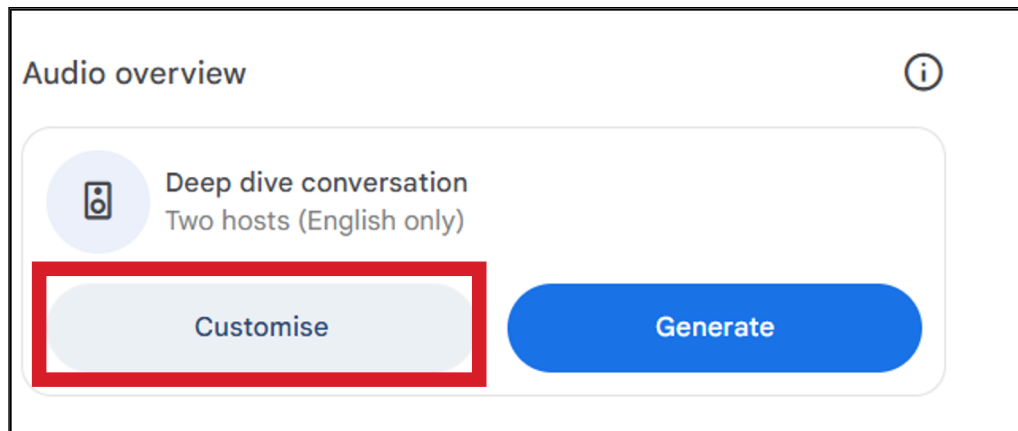
3. In the Website URL box, paste the URL for the website you want to add as a source. For this exercise, you can copy the following URL and paste it. Click **Insert**.

<https://post.parliament.uk/research-briefings/post-pb-0049/>



2. Next, let's generate a customized audio conversation based specifically on the "impact of remote work on employees".

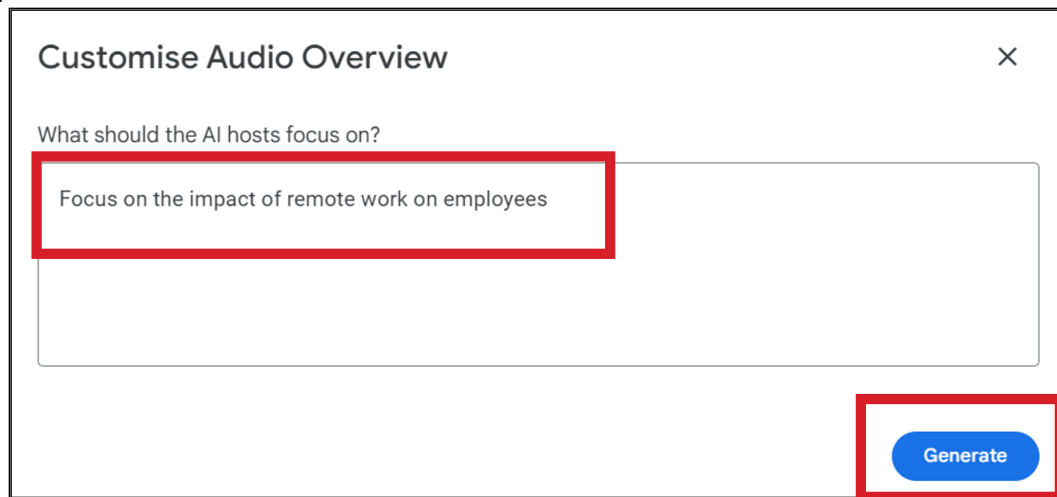
1. Click the **Customise** button in the Audio overview section.



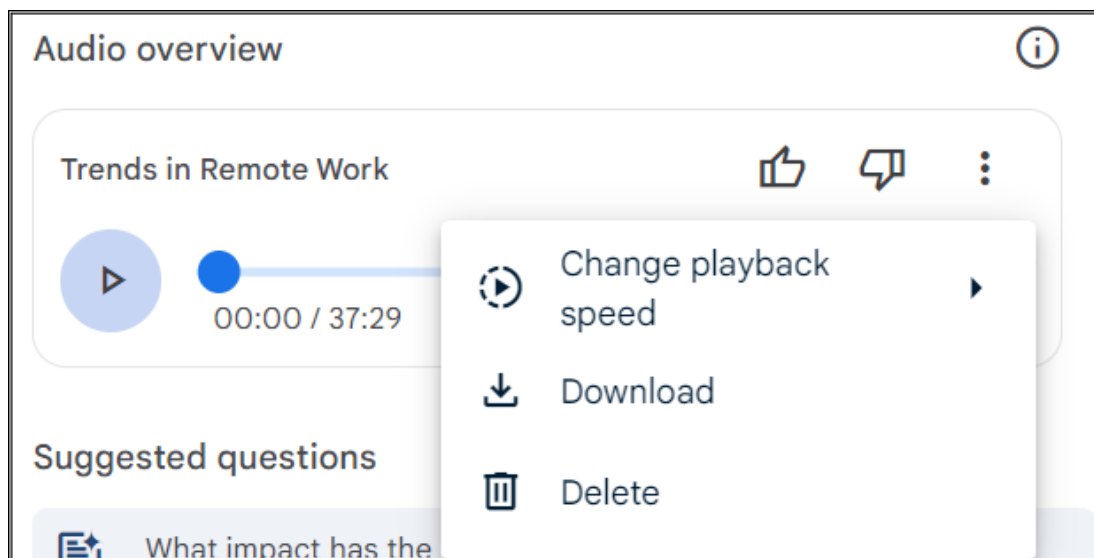
2. In the Customise Audio overview dialog box, add instructions about the customization required in the audio. Copy and paste the following text into the text box.

Focus on the impact of remote work on employees

iii. Click **Generate**.



Within a few minutes, the audio conversation will be ready. You can listen to it directly or download the audio file.



Exercise 2: Leveraging NotebookLM for professional enhancements

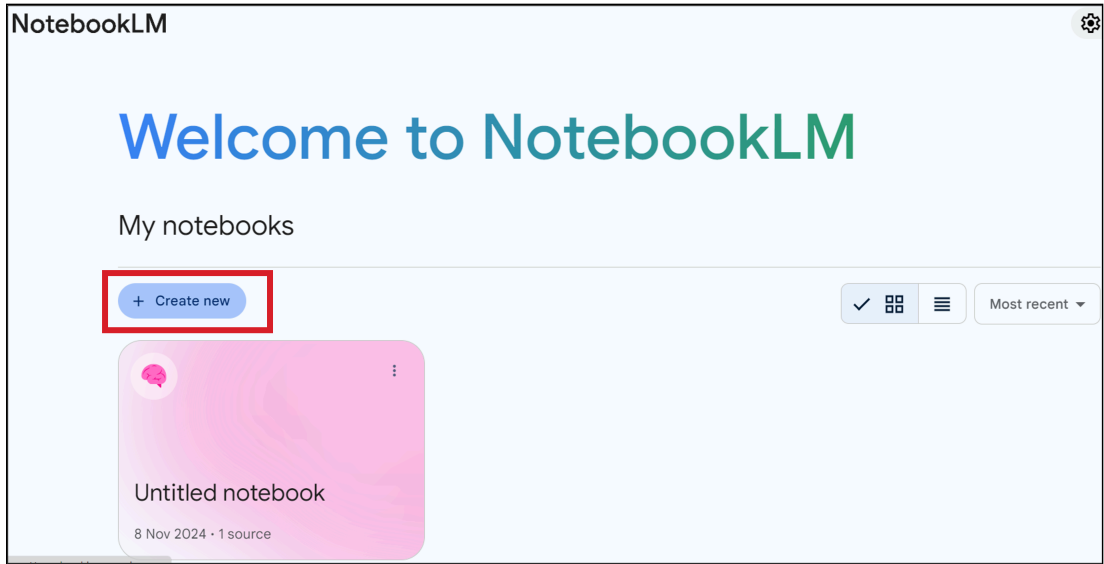
In this exercise, you'll work with an example to demonstrate how professionals in different domains, such as human resources (HR), can use NotebookLM. Gracy, the HR head of a mid-size company, is preparing a presentation for the executive team to propose adopting generative AI in the HR department.

To draft the content of this presentation, she has reviewed various online sources, including industry reports, trends, benefits, and potential use cases of generative AI in HR.

Let's explore how NotebookLM can be useful for this project.

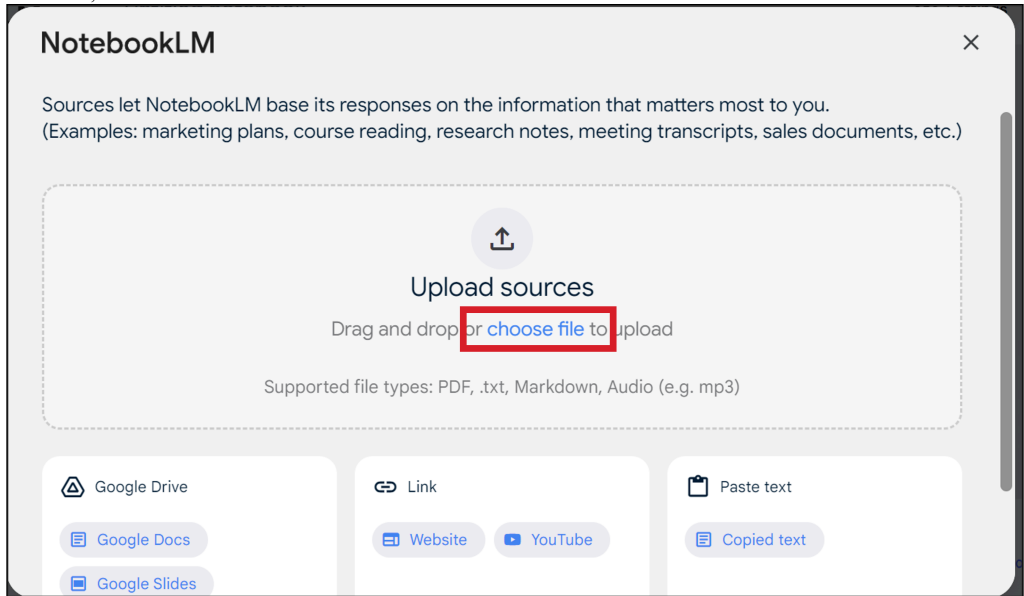
Step 1: Create a new notebook and upload the first source

1. To create a new notebook, click the **Create new** button.

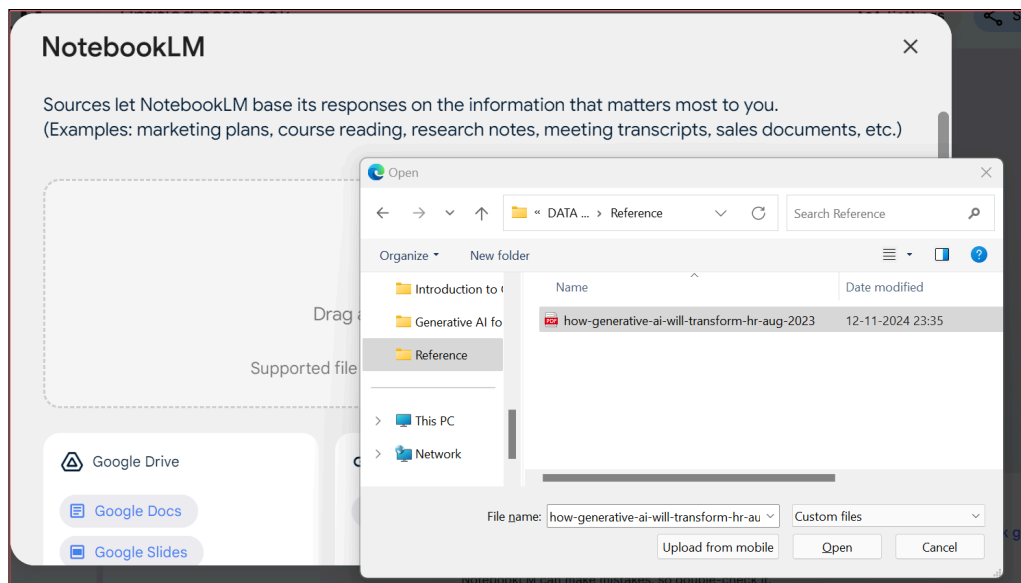


2. A dialog box is displayed that prompts you to upload sources in your notebook. Let's add the first source by uploading a PDF – an article from Boston Consulting Groups (BCG) on How Generative AI Will Transform HR.

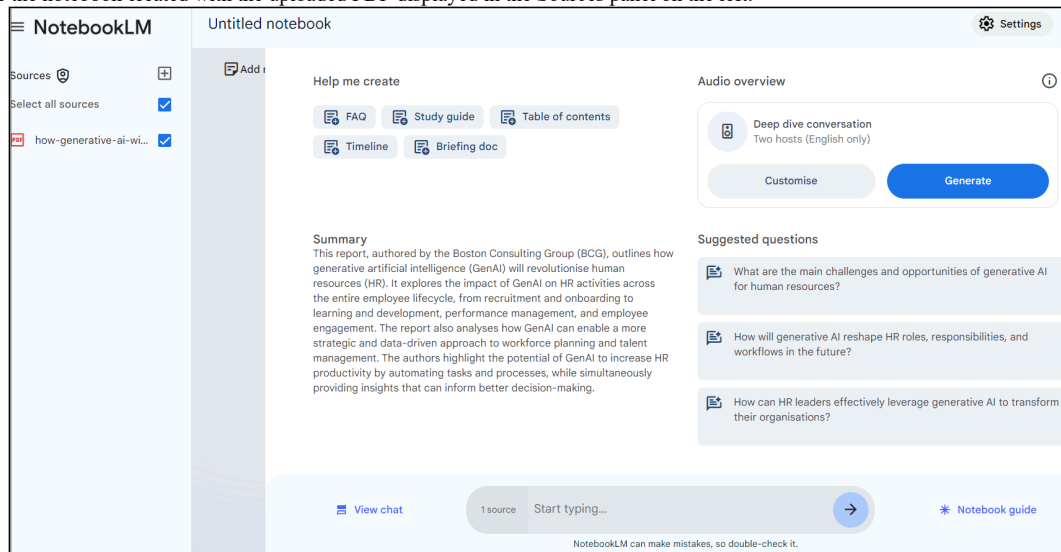
1. In the Upload sources section, click **choose file**.



2. Browse the folder that includes the PDF you want to upload, select the PDF, and click **Open**.

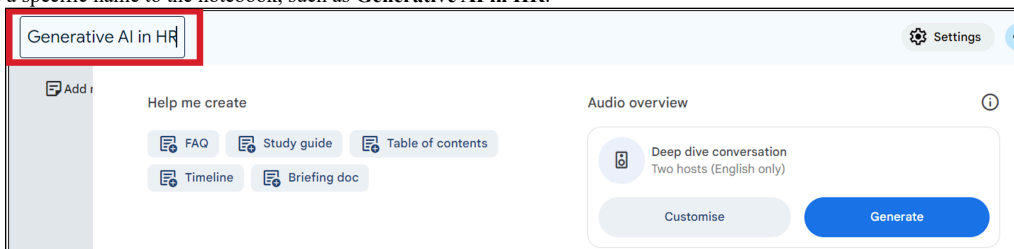


You will have the notebook created with the uploaded PDF displayed in the Sources panel on the left.



Note: If you want to try uploading the same PDF, you can download it from the following link: [Transforming Human Resources using Generative AI](#)

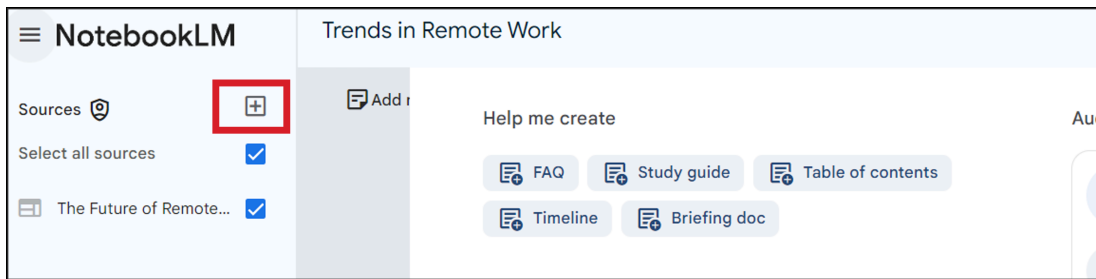
Note: You can give a specific name to the notebook, such as **Generative AI in HR**.



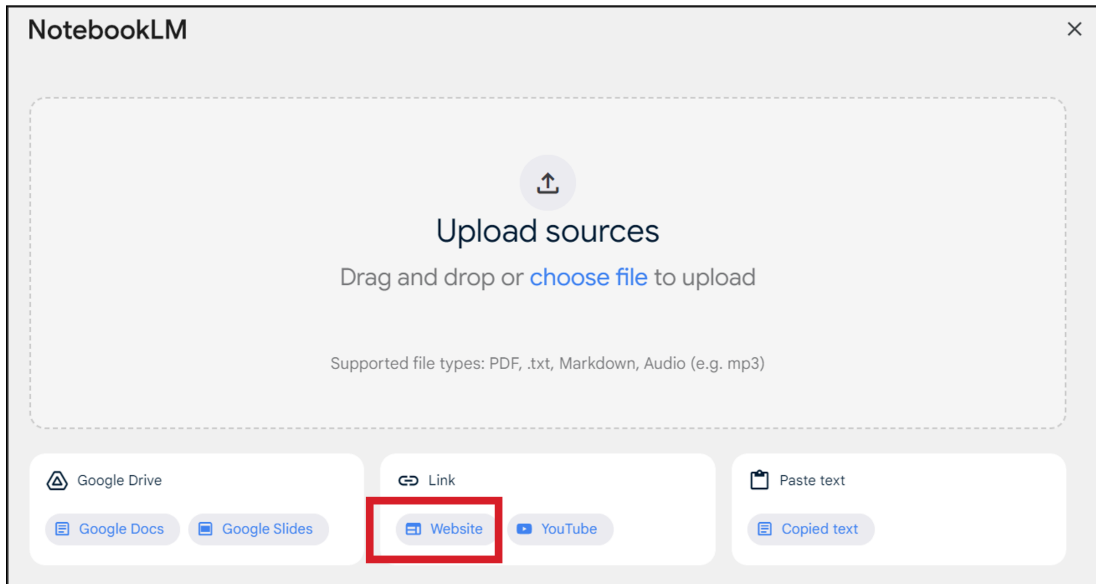
Step 2: Add website URLs as sources

Gracy has identified links to several web pages and YouTube videos to draft the presentation's content. Let's add these as sources in the notebook.

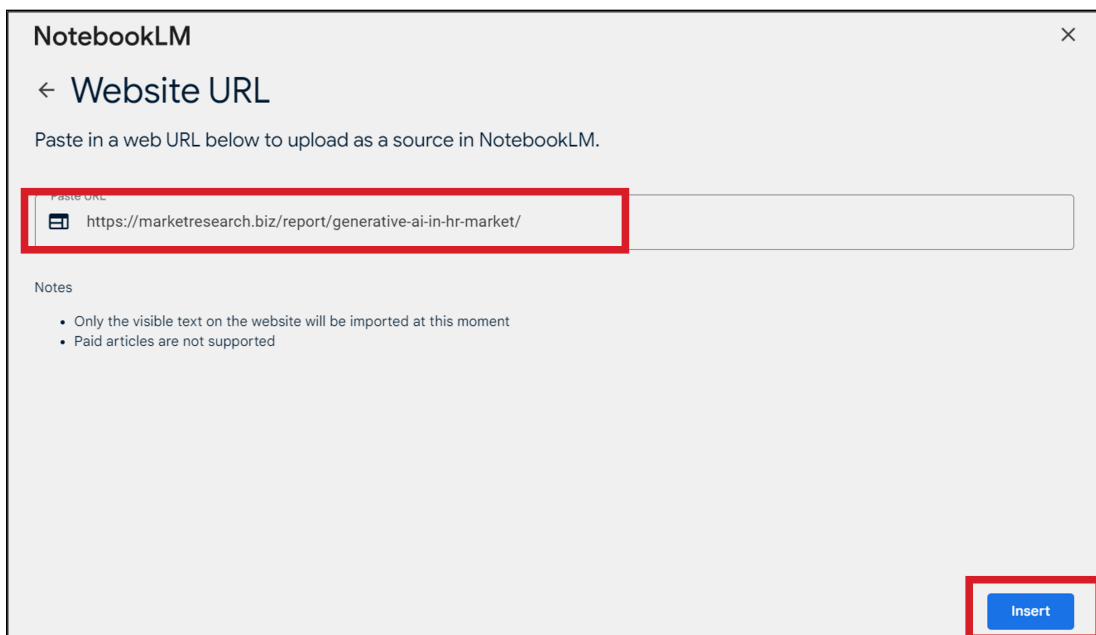
1. In the Sources panel, click the **Add source** icon.



2. In the Add sources dialog box, select **Website** under the Links section.



3. In the Website URL box, paste the URL for the website you want to add as a source. For this exercise, you can copy the following URL and paste it. Click **Insert**.
<https://marketresearch.biz/report/generative-ai-in-hr-market/>



To add other website URLs as sources, follow steps 1 to 3. You can copy and add the following URLs.

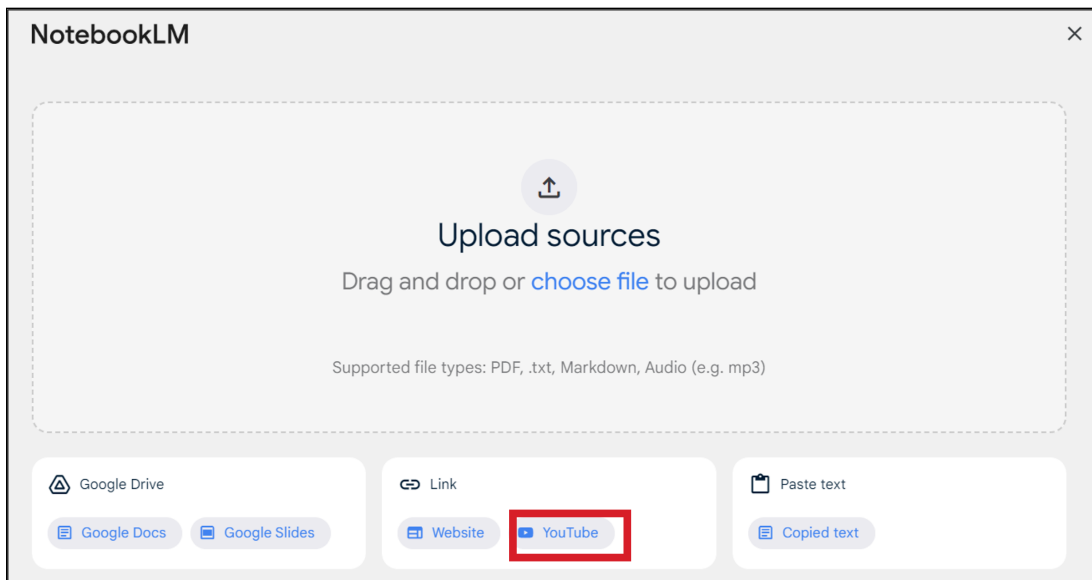
<https://www.bcg.com/publications/2023/transforming-human-resources-using-generative-ai>

<https://www.oracle.com/human-capital-management/hr/generative-ai-hr-use-cases/#::~:~:text=GenAI%20can%20help%20HR%20deliver,tasks%20such%20as%20onboardi>

Step 3: Add links to YouTube videos as sources

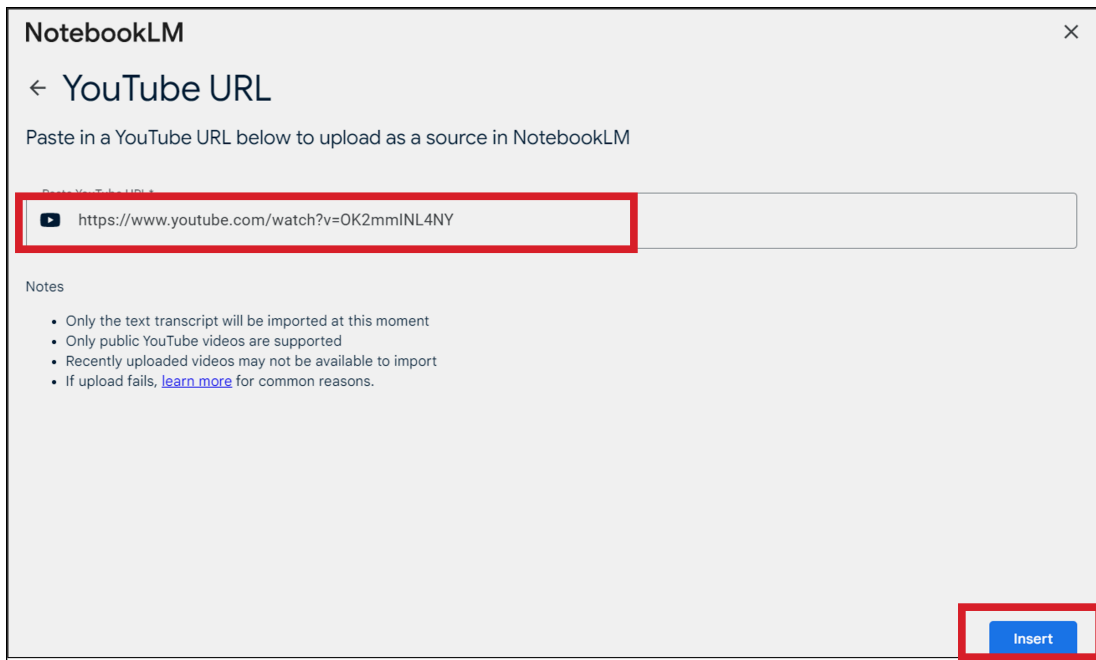
Gracy also explored a YouTube video, "AI for HR," and wants to add this as the source in the notebook.

1. In the Sources panel, click the **Add source** icon.
2. In the Add sources dialog box, select **YouTube** under the Links section.



3. In the YouTube URL, paste the URL for the video you want to add as a source. For this exercise, you can copy the following URL and paste it. Click **Insert**.

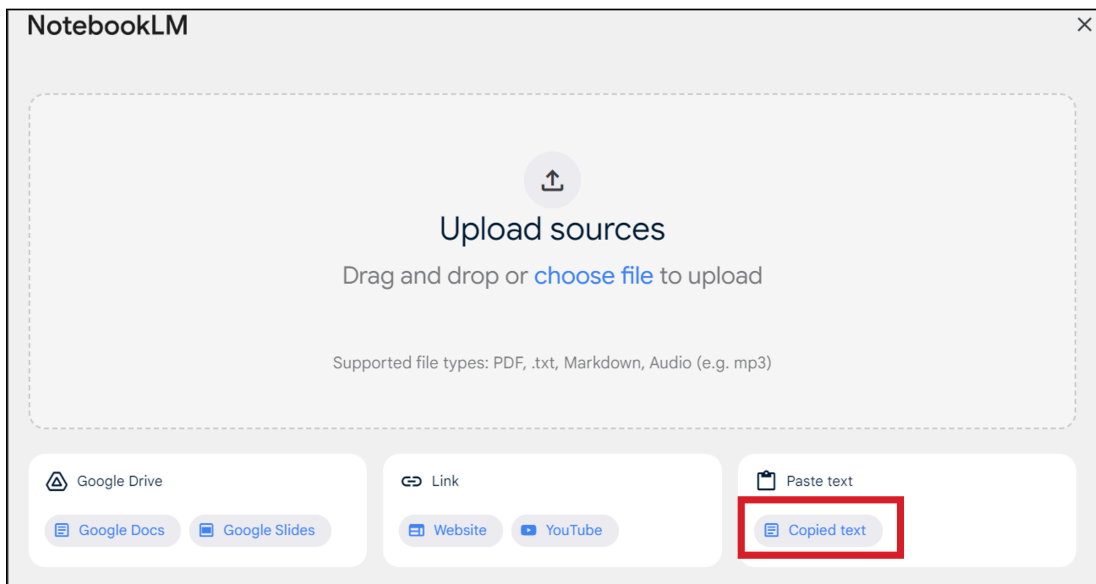
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OK2mmINL4NY>



Step 4: Add copied text as a source

To build her case for the adoption of generative AI, Gracy wants to highlight the current challenges that the HR department is facing and how generative AI can mitigate these challenges. Accordingly, she wants to add the current challenges as a source.

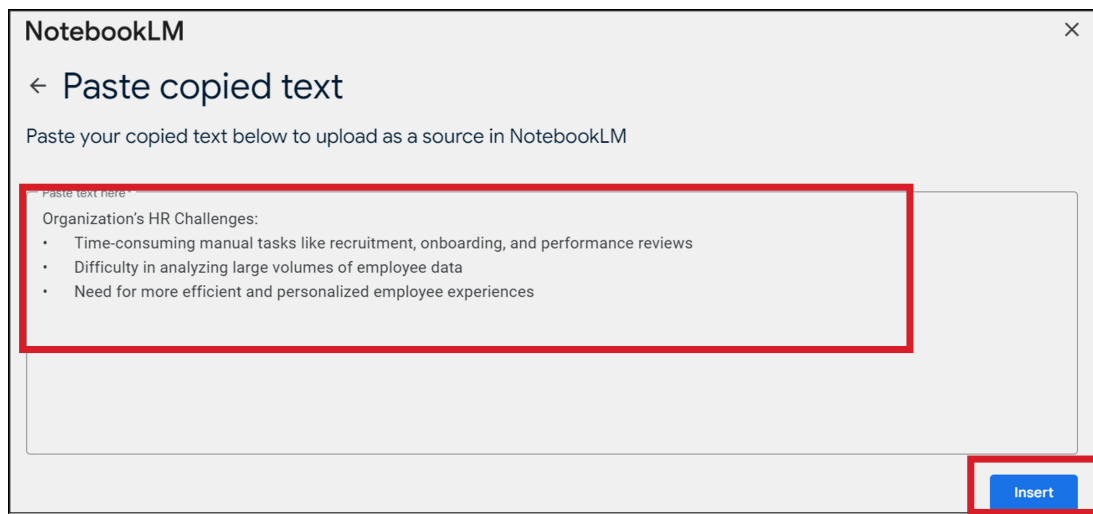
1. In the Sources panel, click the **Add source** icon.
2. In the Add sources dialog box, select **Copied text** under the Paste text section.



3. In the Paste copied box, paste the copied text as a source. For this exercise, you can copy the following text and paste it.

Organization's HR Challenges:

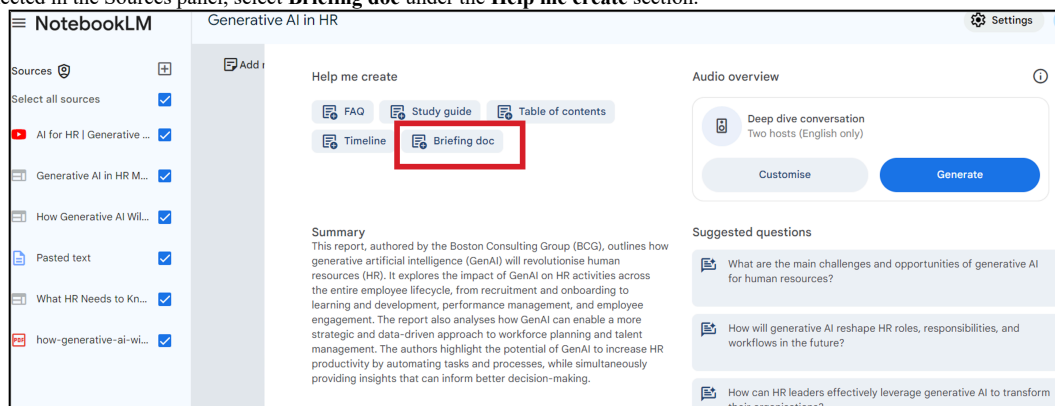
- Time-consuming manual tasks like recruitment, onboarding, and performance reviews
- Difficulty in analyzing large volumes of employee data
- Need for more efficient and personalized employee experiences



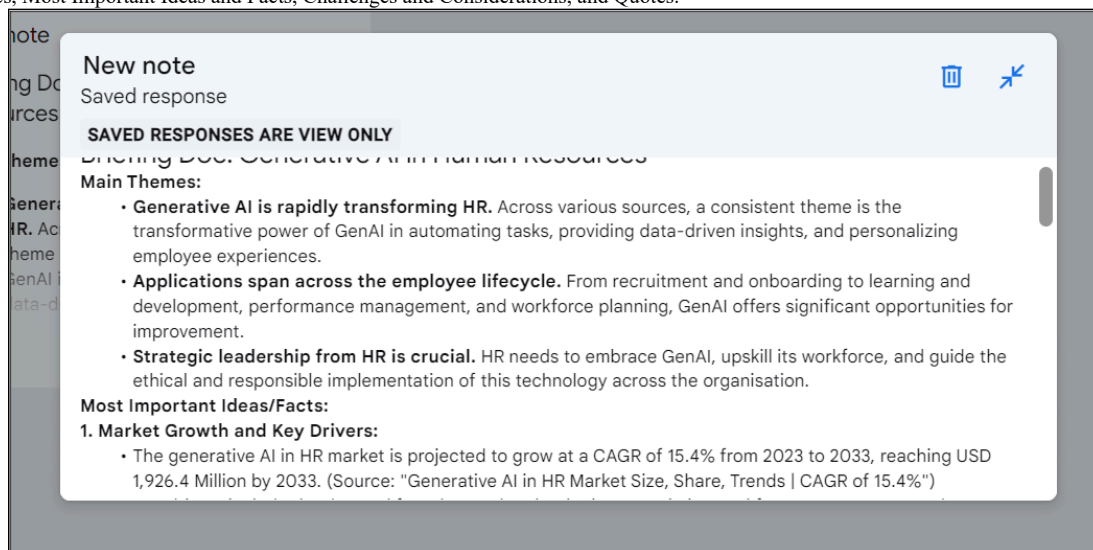
Step 4: Generate and organize the main points using the Briefing Doc option

Gracy wants to generate and organize the main points across her sources for easy reference. The Briefing doc option in the Notebook Guide can be useful for this.

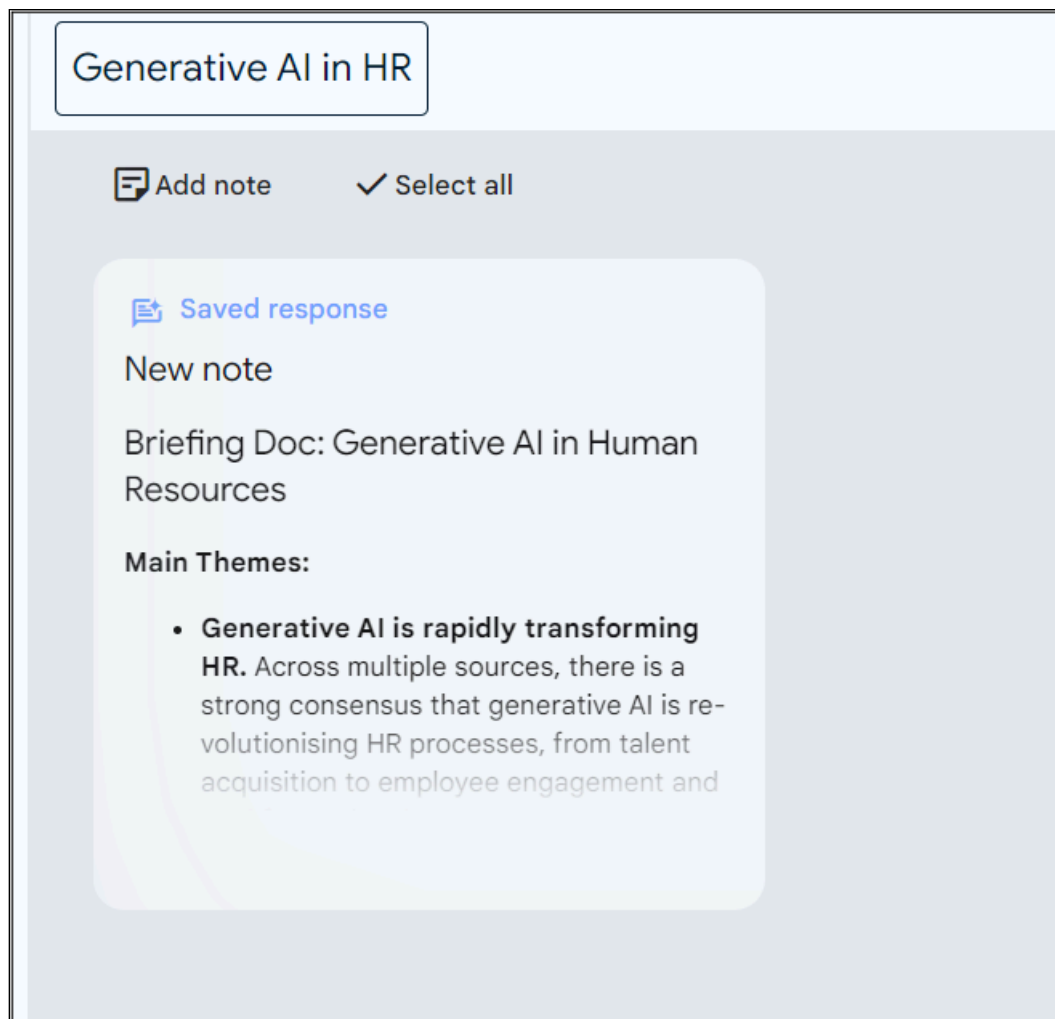
1. With all sources selected in the Sources panel, select **Briefing doc** under the **Help me create** section.



This will display a Briefing Doc based on the content of the sources, organized under different headings. The response generated at our end is organized into headings such as Main Themes, Most Important Ideas and Facts, Challenges and Considerations, and Quotes.

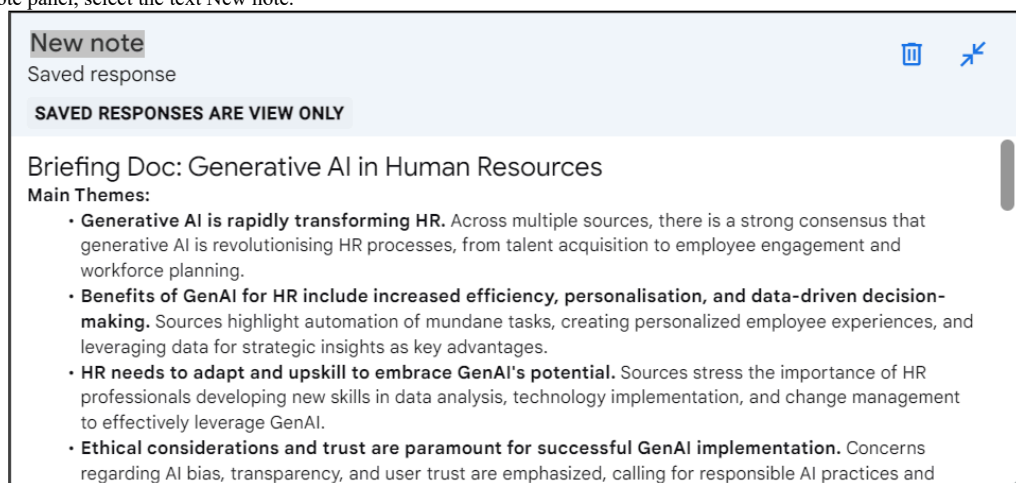


2. You will note that the Briefing Doc generated is saved as a note. Gracy can use this note for organizing the sections of her presentation around the headings of the Briefing Doc.

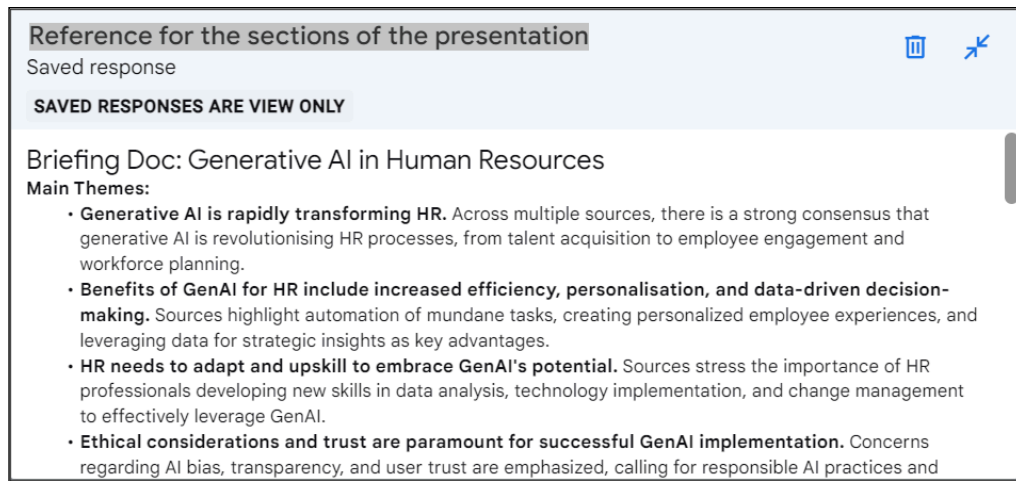


3. Let's give a specific name to this note.

1. Click the New note. This will open the note in a separate panel.
2. At the top of the note panel, select the text New note.



3. Type the name for the note, such as **Reference for the sections of the presentation**.

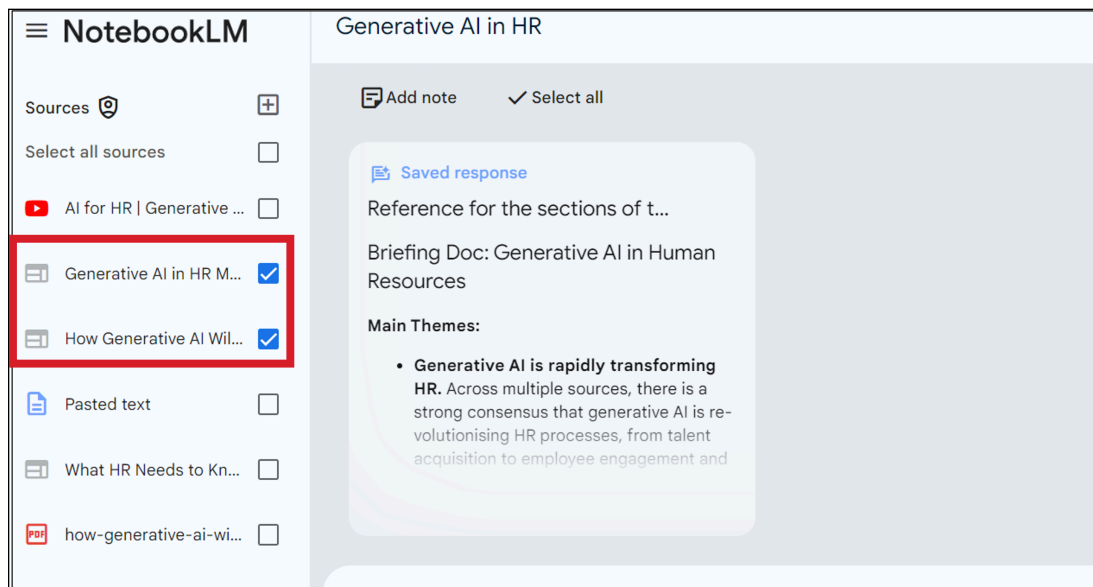


4. Click the **Close** icon.

Step 5: Generating responses for specific questions

Gracy wants to highlight the key trends in the use of generative AI in HR, along with facts and figures. She can extract these trends and figures from the two industry reports uploaded as sources using their website URLs.

1. Select (only) the specific sources on which you want to focus on. In this case, let's select the sources for the two industry reports by MarketResearch.biz and BCG.



2. In the chat box, type a question or statement to generate the required response. Copy the following text and paste it into the chat box.

What are the key trends in the use of generative AI in HR? Provide some facts and figures highlighting these trends.

3. Click the arrow icon next to the chat box to generate the response. The response generated at our end is shown here.

Generative AI in HR

Here are some key trends in the use of generative AI in HR, along with facts and figures from the sources:

Key Trends in Generative AI for HR

- **Increased self-service:** Generative AI allows for more conversational workflows and provides tailored information to employees, which is likely to increase adoption of self-service options ¹.
- **Productivity and experience enhancements:** Current use cases show that generative AI can create and visualise content three times faster, automate over 50% of tasks in onboarding, and achieve recruiting engagement rates twice as high as personalised messages written without AI ¹.
- **Personalised, "always on" delivery of HR services:** Generative AI "copilots" can be used to guide employees and manager careers in real time. AI can help HR understand the rhythm of employees' work, identify their learning and development needs, and provide reminders of goals or programmes ².
- **A comprehensive, data-driven talent ecosystem:** Generative AI's ability to join less structured data sources enables more interconnected use cases, leading to a skills-based talent ecosystem ³.

Facts and Figures Highlighting the Trends

- **Recruiting and hiring is the leading application:** Generative AI is transforming HR, with 28% of innovations occurring in recruiting and hiring processes. This is because AI is being used to enhance efficiency and effectiveness in talent acquisition strategies ⁴.
- **Cloud-based deployment is dominant:** Cloud-based generative AI solutions dominate the HR market with a 68% share. They are preferred due to their scalability, cost-effectiveness, and ease of integration ⁵.
- **Machine learning is a key technology:** Machine learning is the cornerstone of generative AI in HR, used to analyse data and extract meaningful patterns for predictive recommendations, enhanced decision-making, and task automation ⁶.

What is the predicted growth rate of the Generative AI in HR market between 2024 and 2033? According to a report by Gartner, wha

Close chat 2 sources Start typing... → * N

4. You can save a chat response as a note by clicking the **Save to note** icon displayed at the bottom of the response.

Generative AI in HR Setting

They are preferred due to their scalability, cost-effectiveness, and ease of integration ⁵.

- **Machine learning is a key technology:** Machine learning is the cornerstone of generative AI in HR, used to analyse data and extract meaningful patterns for predictive recommendations, enhanced decision-making, and task automation ⁶.
- **North America is the leading region:** The generative AI market in North America's HR sector commands a significant 47% market share, driven by advanced technology, a strong AI industry, and early adoption ⁷.
- **Generative AI can boost productivity up to 30%:** With a balanced human and AI strategy, HR productivity could be boosted by up to 30% in the near future ⁸. One early adopter has reduced its annual HR budget by 10% year-on-year for the past three years ⁸.

Emerging Trends

- **Emphasis on human-machine collaboration:** A key trend is the focus on collaboration between humans and AI. Generative AI is seen as augmenting human capabilities rather than replacing HR professionals ⁹.
- **Investment in career development and mobility:** With AI reshaping jobs and tasks, there is a trend towards investing in career development and mobility for employees displaced by these technologies. Companies are focusing on reskilling and upskilling their workforce ⁷.

📄 👍 💬 Save to note

Summary

Congratulations! You just completed the lab on Leveraging the Potential of Google NotebookLM. In this lab, you explored the features of NotebookLM and how these features can be used by professionals for different use cases.

Author(s)

IBM Skills Network Team



Skills Network